

NovaCore Technologies

Human Resources Policy Handbook — 2026 Edition

Document owner: People Operations **Effective:** 1 January 2026 **Review:** Annual

1. Working Hours and Attendance

NovaCore follows a flexible working model. Standard availability is Monday through Friday, 09:00–18:00 local time, with a one-hour lunch break. Employees may adjust their working hours with manager approval when business and team requirements are met.

- Employees should maintain reliable availability during agreed core hours.
- Planned absences should be communicated to the manager as early as reasonably possible.
- Repeated unexplained lateness or absence may be addressed through the performance process.
- Remote employees must work from an approved location and remain reachable during core hours.

2. Paid Time Off

Full-time employees receive 24 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Leave requests should normally be submitted at least five working days in advance. Managers approve requests based on business coverage and team capacity.

- Unused annual leave may be carried forward by up to 5 days into the following year.
- Sick leave should be reported to the manager before the employee's normal start time where possible.
- Medical documentation may be requested for extended or repeated sick leave, subject to applicable law.

3. Remote Work Policy

Eligible employees may work remotely up to three days per week. New employees normally become eligible after completing their first 90 days, subject to role requirements and manager approval. Certain roles requiring physical presence are excluded.

- Employees are responsible for maintaining a suitable and secure workspace.
- Company devices must not be shared with family members or other unauthorized people.
- Confidential company information must not be discussed in public spaces where it can be overheard.

4. Employee Conduct

NovaCore expects employees to behave professionally and respectfully. Harassment, discrimination, bullying, retaliation, threats, and deliberate intimidation are prohibited.

- Employees must treat colleagues, customers, contractors, and visitors with respect.
- Workplace disagreements should be handled professionally and escalated when necessary.
- Retaliation against an employee who raises a good-faith concern is prohibited.
- Violations may result in corrective action, up to and including termination, subject to applicable law.

5. Information Security and Confidentiality

Employees may access confidential business information, customer data, source code, financial records, and internal documents. Such information must only be accessed and shared for legitimate business purposes.

- Company passwords must be unique and must not be shared.
- Multi-factor authentication must be enabled wherever required by company systems.
- Sensitive files must be stored only in approved company systems.
- Suspected security incidents must be reported to IT Security immediately.
- Employees must return or securely delete company information when their employment ends.

6. Performance and Development

Employees participate in a formal performance review twice each year. Reviews consider delivery, quality, collaboration, professional behavior, and progress against agreed goals. Managers should provide ongoing feedback rather than waiting for the formal review cycle.

- Employees may request a development discussion with their manager at any time.
- The company provides an annual learning allowance of up to USD 1,000 for approved training and certifications.
- Performance concerns should be documented and discussed with the employee before formal corrective action where appropriate.

7. Expense Reimbursement

Reasonable business expenses are reimbursable when they are necessary for company work and comply with the expense guidelines. Receipts are required for individual expenses above USD 25.

- Expense claims should normally be submitted within 30 days.
- Personal expenses, fines, and unauthorized upgrades are not reimbursable.

8. Recruitment and Internal Mobility

NovaCore aims to use consistent and job-related criteria when hiring and promoting employees. Open positions may be advertised internally before or at the same time as external recruitment.

- Hiring decisions should be based on skills, experience, role requirements, and business needs.
- Employees may apply for internal roles when they meet the published eligibility requirements.
- Employees should inform their current manager after progressing to the interview stage, unless local rules require otherwise.

9. Gifts and Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests could improperly influence business decisions. Potential conflicts should be disclosed to the manager or People Operations.

- Cash gifts from vendors or customers are prohibited.
- Non-cash business gifts valued above USD 100 require manager approval and disclosure.
- Employees must disclose outside activities that could materially conflict with their NovaCore responsibilities.

10. Parental and Family Leave

Employees may be eligible for parental, caregiver, adoption, or other family-related leave according to applicable law and company benefits. Employees should contact People Operations as early as practical to understand eligibility, documentation, and scheduling requirements.

11. Grievances and Reporting Concerns

Employees who believe a policy has been violated may raise a concern with their manager, People Operations, or the confidential ethics reporting channel. Reports made in good faith will be handled as confidentially as reasonably possible. NovaCore prohibits retaliation for good-faith reports.

12. Policy Administration

People Operations owns this handbook and may update policies when business needs, regulations, or company practices change. Where local law provides greater employee protections than this handbook, applicable law prevails.